Award Modification / Notice of Award

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR / BUREAU OF INTERNATIONAL LABOR AFFAIRS

Award Modification	**No. 2**	PROJECT: MEXICO AWARENESS RAISING PROJECT	
AWARD NUMBER: IL-35868-21-75-K-	EIN: 520848769	EFFECTIVE DATE: 09/20/2022	PAGE 1
RECIPIENT: PARTNERS OF THE AMERICAS 1424 K ST. NW; SUITE 700 WASHINGTON, DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA 20005-2410		ISSUED BY: U.S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR / ILAB ETA OFFICE OF GRANTS MANAGEMENT 200 CONSTITUTION AVENUE, N.W. WASHINGTON, DC 20210	

Action:
This modification is to accept the appointment of Ms. Ingrid Ceballos as the new Project Director (PD) and Key Personnel for the Mexico Awareness Raising Project, to replace Project Director Dr. Gabriela Mendoza, who served in the position until July 31, 2022.

As required in the attached Grant Officer Conditions, Partners of the Americas must 1) adhere to its attached training plan for capacity building and courses on grant management for Ms. Ceballos and 2) report back on Ms. Ceballos' progress to independence as the in-country PD for the Mexico Awareness Raising Project in subsequent technical progress reports.

This modification is also to replace FPO/GOR Kelsey Schrenk with Carolina Chavez.
Carolina Chaves
Phone: (202) 693-2992
Email: chavez.carolina@dol.gov

YEAR / CFDA PROGRAM ACCOUNT ID	**Mod 0-1 CURRENT LEVEL**	**Mod 2 MODIFICATION**	**NEW LEVEL**	**PMS DOC #**
FY 21 / 17.401 - International Labor Programs Office of Trade and Labor Affairs 20-1605-2021-2501652024BD20210165034320MILAB0M0000MUSMCAMILOTL-M9K106-410043---	$10,000,000.00	$0.00	$10,000,000.00	IL35868U01
TOTAL FUND AVAILABILITY	**$10,000,000.00**	**$0.00**	**$10,000,000.00**	

Except as modified, all terms and conditions of said agreement remain unchanged and in full effect.

Approved by **Date Signed** **10/05/2022**

Bradley Sickles

Grant Officer
sickles.bradley.a@dol.gov

Close Print

GRANT OFFICER CONDITIONS

Partners of the Americas (POA)

The following conditions are required to be reported on by the recipient in subsequent technical progress reports:

1. **Condition 1 KEY PERSONNEL REQUIREMENT**
   The FOA instructions states that the Project Director (PD) for the project have a "Minimum of ten (10) years of experience in project management, supervision, administration, and implementation of cooperative agreement and/or contract requirements (including meeting deadlines, achieving targets, establishing and maintaining systems for managing project operations, and overseeing the preparation and submission of required reports to donor agencies." Partners of the Americas (POA) acknowledges in its Project Revision Form, Project Order Authorization Form, and Project Director's Requirements Table that Ms. Ceballos does not have this prerequisite experience. As such, the organization must follow its training plan outlined in the attached October 4, 2022, response to the Office of Grants Management's request for additional information and report on Ms. Ceballos' progress to independence as the in-country PD for the Mexico Awareness Raising Project.

2. **Condition 2 SALARY DIFFERENTIAL FOLLOW UP**
   Ms. Ceballos' anticipated salary is significantly lower than salaries Partners of the Americas paid to previous Project Directors as noted in POA's October 4, 2022, response to the Office of Grants Management's request for additional information. POA states in the response this is "based on education level, years of experience, and relevant/needed skills, along with location." A Salary.com review lists a Mexico PD salary range as USD$112,171 – USD$179,207 (MXN$2,281K - MXN$3,644K) as of April 2021. POA is required to review Ms. Ceballos' salary based on her post-training performance and subsequent progress to bring her salary within the competitive Mexico PD range.

Thurlow, Cynthia - ETA

From: Chavez, Carolina - ILAB
Sent: Tuesday, October 4, 2022 9:15 AM
To: Thurlow, Cynthia - ETA
Cc: cpena@partners.net
Subject: FW: DRAFT More info for PD modification

Hi Carmen, thank you for your response. Cynthia, see below. I'd adding Carmen to the message due to the time sensitive nature of this modification. I will note that both Midling and Mendoza had PhDs and several more years' experience than Ingrid does though her salary is comparable to other Mexico-based Project Directors.

Please let Carmen or me know if you need additional information. Best,

Carolina

From: Carmen Peña <cpena@partners.net>
Sent: Monday, October 3, 2022 10:20 PM
To: Chavez, Carolina - ILAB <Chavez.Carolina@dol.gov>
Subject: Re: DRAFT More info for PD modification

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the Department of Labor. Do not click (select) links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe. Report suspicious emails through the "Report Phishing" button on your email toolbar.

Hi Carolina,

Many thanks for your message.

Please see responses to the GO's inquires below.

1. **Official reasons for Dr. Michael Midling's and Dr. Gabriela Mendoza's departure.**

Dr. Michalel Midling's departure from MAP was due to an internal process that had been ongoing in regards to his performance and significant concerns from home office regarding the project's progress during Year 1. POA provided opportunities for improvement but unfortunately, we did not see the needed changes within the committed timeframes. Dr. Midling received verbal warning, written warning and finally, he was placed in a Performance Improvement Plan hoping to give him an opportunity to address failures to meet specific tasks and job goals. Even with a PIP in place, Dr. Midling did not address significant concerns, creating even further delays for the project, confusion among other staff regarding their roles and priorities, ultimately leading to his removal from POA and the project.

Dr. Gabriela Mendoza's cited personal reasons for her departure. Dr. Mendoza resigned within two months of starting the job communicating to POA she was unable to provide 100% LOE to the project. She had other personal matters to take care of and she was fully aware and understood that the project needed someone that had full availability and commitment, even though POA had communicated this to her during the hiring process.

2. **Confirmation of actual salary POA paid the previous PDs, intended salary for Ms. Ingrid Ceballos, and information regarding how the salaries were determined.**

POA determines salaries based on education level, years of experience, and relevant/needed skills, along with location.

Dr. Midling's salary: $13,500/monthly.

- Dr. Midling belonged to POA's payroll in the United States.
- Dr. Midling provided Biographical Employee Data.

Dr. Mendoza's salary: $12,755.42/monthly

- Dr. Mendoza belonged to POA's payroll in Mexico.

- Head hunter provided Biographical Employee Data.

Ms. Ingrid Ceballos's proposed salary: $7,500/monthly

- Ms. Ceballos will belong to POA's payroll in Mexico.
- Ms. Ceballos provided supporting documentation regarding current compensation.

3. **Detailed training plan that includes timeframes for the trainings, capacity building, and courses on grant management that will be provided to Ms. Ingrid Ceballos.**

Please see below draft schedule of trainings, capacity building and courses we are working on for Ms. Ceballos's upon her incorporation to POA and MAP.

Dates	Training Topics	Responsible
October 10 -14, 2022 (TBC)	USG Rules and Regulations (online): Step-by-step through the structure of USG rules and regulations and introduction to the USG Award cycle, maintaining donor compliance, learn how to build strong working relationships with the donor and develop policies for successful management of the cooperative agreement.	Humentum
October 17 – 21, 2022	POA Home Office introduction to field staff, key stakeholders and sub-awards. Overview on donor mandatory rules and regulations (MPG – USDOL, etc.). Orientation on Project Document, Budget, Allowability of costs under USG and compliance checks, M&E processes and requirements. Reporting requirements, Technical Progress Report (October 2022). Introduction to POA policies, procedures and systems. (In Person, Mexico City)	POA Home Office (Carmen Pena and Macarena Jimenez)

October 24 – 28, 2022	New PD Orientation Session (online): POA's travel policy and procedures. POA's procurement policy and procedures. Document management system: PandaDoc. Replicon: time reporting, time off, and expense reporting	Debbie Cooper, CFO and Danielle Martin, Director of Compliance
October 26-November 4, 2022	Management Skills for NGOs (online): Learn communication strategies, strengthen interpersonal skills, and apply effective techniques.	Humentum
November 9 – December 20, 2022	Fighting Fraud in NGOs (online): Build the skills and confidence of as an NGO and INGO staff member to prevent fraud, detect it, and manage incidences effectively. Acquire knowledge, tools, and resources needed for INGO and NGO anti-corruption.	Humentum
November 1-4, 2022	POA Summit in Colombia. Introduction to POA's Board of Directors, Senior Leadership Team, Admin and Finance staff and meet/greet other projects throughout the region. (In-person, Bogota, Colombia)	POA
November 14 – 18, 2022	Travel to Washington, DC. Home office orientation and meetings with USDOL.	POA Home Office and USDOL
December 5 – 9, 2022	New PD Orientation Session (in person): Cash flow management and financial reporting processes and procedures for the field office. Budgets, budget realignments and Grant Report Training. Contract types and processes. Subaward management. Inventory management.	Danielle Martin, Director of Compliance

Bi-weekly	Overview of project progress and key deliverables Review work plan and budget Discuss high level strategic decisions Assess relationship and engagement with sub-awardees and key stakeholders	Carmen Pena, VP, Child Protection Unit
Monthly (recurring)	Executive Coaching/ Touchpoint with HR (online)	Natalie Abegesah, VP, Human Resources
Daily (informally) and Weekly (meetings)	Day to day priorities and project needs. Reporting to USDOL, informal and formally (TPRs, bi-weekly meeting preparations, etc). Orientation and guidance regarding USDOL requirements, rules and regulations	Macarena Jimenez, Senior Director, Child Protection Unit

Please let me know if you need additional information or have any questions/feedback.

Many thanks,

Carmen

PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
Connect • Serve • Change Lives

POA-202209-009

September 14th, 2022

Ms. Carolina Chavez
International Relations Officer
Office of Trade and Labor Affairs
Bureau of International Labor Affairs
U.S. Department of Labor
Washington, DC

Cooperative Agreement Number: IL-35868-21-75-K

Dear Ms. Chavez:

The purpose of this Project Revision is to request approval to replace Key Personnel – Project Director (PD).

Partners of the Americas (POA) is aware and supports the enclosed Project Revision submitted on September 14th, 2022.

Please let me know if you have any questions or require additional information.

Sincerely,

John McPhail
President and CEO
Partners of the Americas
jmcphail@partners.net

Project Revision Form

PROJECT REVISION FORM

Project Title:	Mexico Awareness Raising Project (MAP)
Recipient:	Partners of the Americas, Inc (POA)
Cooperative Agreement Number:	IL-35868-21-75-K
USDOL Appropriation Number:	20-1605-2021-2501652024BD20210165034320MILAB0M0000MUSMCAMILOTL-M9K106-410043
Submission and Resubmission Dates:	September 14, 2022

BACKGROUND AND JUSTIFICATION FOR PROJECT REVISION

The purpose of this Project Revision is to: 1) Request approval to replace Key Personnel position – Project Director (PD).

1. Request approval to replace Key Personnel – Project Director (PD)

Partners of the Americas (POA) requests approval to replace Key Personnel Project Director (PD) position with Ms. Ingrid Amalia Ceballos Gastrado effective upon approval of this Project Revision, dedicating 100% Level of Effort (LOE) to the project. POA regards as crucial hiring a PD with proven leadership and technical skills to manage the Mexico Awareness Raising Project. In this context, POA has identified Ms. Ceballos as the most qualified professional for the PD position, considering she brings over ten years of professional experience in leadership, cross-sectoral collaboration, and project management, as well as expertise in development and political topics such as labor reform, human rights, international cooperation, education, and communication, along with her skills in project design, monitoring, and oversight are apparent throughout her career.

POA recognizes that Ms. Ceballos does not have experience in managing cooperative agreements funded specifically by the U.S. Government (USG). However, POA's home office will be working closely with Ms. Ceballos daily, providing training, guidance, and support to build her understanding of and ability to comply with USG-funded cooperative agreements including federal rules and regulations (CFRs) and USDOL's Management Procedures and Guidelines (MPG). These efforts will include visits from home office staff to POA's office in Mexico City, and orientation meetings for the new Project Director in Washington, DC, trainings provided by POA's Chief Financial Officer and the Director of Grants and Compliance, courses on grant management such as those offered by Humentum, and daily check-ins with POA's Senior Director, who have a vast experience managing USG grants and cooperative agreements. Additionally, Ms. Ceballos will have the support of the Deputy Project Director, Director of Administration and Finance, Project Assistant, Finance Officer, and other POA staff in Mexico who have been working on the project and have developed a strong understanding of grants management and compliance.

Given her valuable professional experience, in-depth technical knowledge of the Mexican Labor Reform and the United States-Canada-Mexico Agreement (USMCA), first-hand understanding of both national and

international standards and requirements concerning trade, labor rights, and worker organization, and demonstrated ability to build cooperative relationships with diverse local, national and international stakeholders, engaging them in projects and identifying areas for collaboration, POA believes that Ms. Ceballos will be able to lead the project and strengthen the project's staffing for an effective implementation of activities to achieve the expected outcomes.

Ms. Ceballos is native Spanish speaker and fluent in English.

Please find below key highlights from her professional experience:

- She currently serves as the General Director for International Affairs at the Mexican Secretariat of Labor and Social Welfare (STPS) for three and a half years. In this role, she has liaised on behalf of the STPS with key national and international stakeholders, including the International Labor Organization, G20, The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development, the Organization of American States, and the Pacific Alliance. Ms. Ceballos has a demonstrated ability to build cooperative relationships with diverse international stakeholders, engaging them in projects and identifying areas for collaboration. Managing a team of twelve, her primary focus is the implementation of the Mexican Labor reform and the USMCA.
- As the Director of Educational Affairs at the Mexican Ministry of Education for ten months from February to December 2018, she led the development of communication strategies and negotiation tactics for educational governance, particularly focusing on professors' unions. She developed activities and campaigns regarding education targeted towards worker organizations, demonstrating her ability to effectively communicate and collaborate with such organizations in the promotion of a shared objective
- As the Procurement Manager at the Mexican Institute for Family and Population Research for eight months from May 2017 to January 2018, she acted as the institutional liaison to build relationships and strategic partnerships with potential new donors and grantees. This position strengthened her ability to communicate with key stakeholders to develop projects striving towards shared objectives.
- As the Deputy Director of Monitoring and Evaluation for the Chief of Staff's Office of the Presidency of the Republic for over two and a half years, from January 2013 through September 2015, she led the monitoring and evaluation of Mexico's progress towards the United Nations' Millennium Development Goals (MDGs). Her responsibilities included leading the development of the 2014 and 2016 MGDs Progress Reports for Mexico.
- As the Senior Political Media Advisor for the presidential campaign of Peña Nieto for one year, from January to December 2012, her responsibilities included coordinating the development of daily strategic media reports to assist the campaign's "war room" in decision-making and strategy building. She created evidence-based and goal-oriented reports to provide the campaign with thorough, pertinent communications information.
- She served as a Senior Political Consultant for Pulso Legislativo for eight months from April through December 2011
- She served as a Program Liaison for the Oportunidades Human Development program of the Ministry of Social Development for seven months, from May through December 2010
- As a Junior Political Consultant at the Chamber of Deputies for seven months from September 2009 through April 2010, she was responsible for monitoring, analyzing, and reporting on the work performed by the Finance, Economy and Communications Committees, as well as following up general legislative processes.
- She served as a Liaison Analyst at the National Electoral Institute for four months from March through July 2009.

Please find attached Ms. Ceballos' CV.

EFFECTS OF REVISION ON THE PROJECT

Project Element	Current Project Status	Proposed Changes
Geographical areas		No change
Target group – direct beneficiaries		No change
Indicators – project objective and outcome levels		No change
Program strategies leading to significant change in project outcomes and outputs		No change
Key personnel	Dr. Gabriela Mendoza served as Project Director until July 31, 2022.	Ms. Ingrid Ceballos as Project Director.
Budget		No change
Project duration / end date		No change
Other (please specify)		

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

Please find attached Ms. Ingrid Ceballos' CV.

Ingrid Amalia Ceballos Gaystardo
Project Director

SUMMARY

Ms. Ingrid Amalia Ceballos Gastrado is a native Mexican with a bachelor's degree in Political Science and Public Administration from the National Autonomous University of Mexico and a master's degree in Global Health from the University of Southampton. She brings over ten years of professional experience in leadership, cross-sectoral collaboration, and project management. Her expertise in development and political topics such as labor reform, human rights, international cooperation, education, and communication, along with her skills in project design, monitoring, and oversight are apparent throughout her career. Since 2019, she has served as the General Director for International Affairs at the Mexican Secretariat of Labor and Social Welfare (STPS), where she liaises with key international stakeholders such as the International Labor Organization, the Organization of American States, and the Pacific Alliance. Her work, centered on the Mexican Labor Reform and the United States-Canada-Mexico Agreement (USMCA), has given her a nuanced and first-hand understanding of both national and international standards and requirements concerning trade, labor rights, and worker organizations. She manages a team of twelve employees and a project portfolio of over 80 million U.S. dollars. Prior to her current position, Ms. Ceballos served as the Director of Educational Affairs for the Mexican Ministry of Education. Her primary responsibilities included leading the development of communication and negotiation strategies for engagement with teachers' unions and the management of the Ministry's risk agenda. This position highlights her abilities to both engage with workers organizations and identify and mitigate potential threats to successful project implementation. From May 2017 through January 2018, Ms. Ceballos was the Procurement Manager for the Mexican Institute for Family and Population Research. In this position, she developed relationships with potential donors and partners, identifying new grants and project opportunities for the organization. She also led the technical design of proposals for new projects, demonstrating her nuanced understanding of project structure, including activities, outcomes, and objectives. From January 2013 through September 2015, she was the Deputy Director of Monitoring and Evaluation in the Chief of Staff's Office of the Presidency of the Republic. In this position, she monitored Mexico's advancement towards the United Nations' Millennium Development Goals, leading the development of Mexico's 2014 and 2016 reports and activities to inform the MDG 2030 Agneda. From January through December 2012, Ms. Ceballos was the Senior Media Political Advisor for the presidential campaign of Peña Nieto. In this role, she created evidence-based strategic media points every day, used to inform the campaign's political and communications strategy. From April through December 2011, she was a Senior Political Consultant for Pulso Legislativo, developing tools to track legislative and political trends for the firm's clients. Her ability to monitor and evaluate data and prepare informative and results-oriented reports is evident from both positions. From May through December 2010, Ms. Ceballos was a Program Liaison for the Oportunidades Human Development Program, run by the Mexican Ministry of Social Development (SEDESOL). In this position, she networked with key government and private institutions in Mexico, promoting the objectives of the program. She advocated to ease the requirements scheme for the health components of the social protection program, seeking to create a more accessible program for Mexican citizens. Prior to this position, from September 2009 through April 2010, Ms. Ceballos was a Junior Political consultant for the Chamber of Deputies, where she was responsible for monitoring, analyzing and reporting on the work performed by the Finance, Economy and Communications Committees. This position also allowed her to learn lobbying techniques, particularly communication, collaboration, and negotiation. From March through July 2009, she was a Liaison Analyst at the National Electoral Institute, where she collaborated in designing the promotion strategies for the Preliminary Electoral Results Program (PREP). She also took part in the coordination of meetings with all political parties and with the Technical Advisory Committee for the PREP, in order to reach consensus on the program's operation and functioning. Ms. Ceballos' earlier experiences helped her to build skills in collaboration and partnership-building with key stakeholders, engaging stakeholders to advance towards shared goals and objectives. Spanish is Ms. Ceballos' native language, and she is fluent in Spanish.

EXPERIENCE

General Director for International Affairs
Secretariat of Labor and Social Welfare (STPS), Mexico City, Mexico
January 2019 – Present

Ms. Ceballos has served as the General Director for International Affairs at the STPS for three and a half years. In this role, she has liaised on behalf of the STPS with key national and international stakeholders, including the International Labor Organization, G20, The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development, the Organization of American States, and the Pacific Alliance. Ms. Ceballos has a demonstrated ability to build cooperative relationships with diverse international stakeholders, engaging them in projects and identifying areas for collaboration. Managing a team of twelve, her primary focus is the implementation of the Mexican Labor reform and the USMCA. As such, she has a nuanced understanding of both the USMCA and the labor reform, including their development, goals, and implementation. Her responsibilities also include building and strengthening bilateral cooperation with foreign governments and international organizations in the promotion of trade agreements, labor reform, and labor rights. She currently manages a project portfolio valued at over 80 million U.S. dollars and serves as the primary point of contact within the STPS for other Mexican Government ministries and entities. Her current position highlights Ms. Ceballos' leadership, management, and relationship building abilities, particularly within the thematic areas of labor reform, trade, and labor rights.

Director of Educational Affairs
Ministry of Education, Mexico City, Mexico
February 2018 –December 2018

Ms. Ceballos served as the Director of Educational Affairs at the Mexican Ministry of Education for ten months from February to December 2018. In this role, she led the development of communication strategies and negotiation tactics for educational governance, particularly focusing on professors' unions. She developed activities and campaigns regarding education targeted towards worker organizations, demonstrating her ability to effectively communicate and collaborate with such organizations in the promotion of a shared objective. Ms. Ceballos also coordinated the Ministry's institutional risk agenda, including the design of strategies and protocols for risk and crisis management. Her risk management experience highlights her ability to not only develop, but efficiently and proactively manage projects, anticipating and mitigating potential threats to implementation or sustainability.

Procurement Manager
Mexican Institute for Family and Population Research, Mexico City, Mexico
May 2017 –January 2018

Ms. Ceballos served as the Procurement Manager at the Mexican Institute for Family and Population Research for eight months from May 2017 to January 2018. In this role, she acted as the institutional liaison to build relationships and strategic partnerships with potential new donors and grantees. This position strengthened her ability to communicate with key stakeholders to develop projects striving towards shared objectives. Additionally, Ms. Ceballos led the development of technical proposals for funding, procurement, and grants for projects related to health, education, productivity, and citizenship. Ms. Ceballos' brings experience not only in partnership building for cooperative agreements, but also the development of project strategies and activities, highlighting her comprehensive understanding of projects promoting welfare and development.

Deputy Director of Monitoring and Evaluation
Presidency of the Republic, Chief of Staff´s Office, Mexico City, Mexico
January 2013 – September 2015

Ms. Ceballos served as the Deputy Director of Monitoring and Evaluation for the Chief of Staff's Office of the Presidency of the Republic for over two and a half years, from January 2013 through September 2015. In this role, she led the monitoring

and evaluation of Mexico's progress towards the United Nations' Millennium Development Goals (MDGs). Her responsibilities included leading the development of the 2014 and 2016 MGDs Progress Reports for Mexico. This position developed her capacity to effectively monitor and share the progress of Mexico's efforts to promote sustainable human and economic development. Additionally, Ms. Ceballos organized activities, including workshops and studies, that paved the way towards the development of the MDGs' Agenda 2030. This experience demonstrates her ability to not only monitor progress towards development goals, but design activities and strategies for day-to-day implementation of projects.

Senior Political Media Advisor
Presidential Campaign of Peña Nieto, Mexico City, Mexico
January 2012 – December 2012

Ms. Ceballos served as the Senior Political Media Advisor for the presidential campaign of Peña Nieto for one year, from January to December 2012. Her responsibilities included coordinating the development of daily strategic media reports to assist the campaign's "war room" in decision-making and strategy building. She created evidence-based and goal-oriented reports to provide the campaign with thorough, pertinent communications information. Additionally, as a part of the transitional government, she collaborated on the education sector diagnosis. The findings of that diagnostic served as the cornerstone of the landmark 2013Mexican Education Reform Bill. Ms. Ceballos' thorough and insightful contributions to the diagnostic provided invaluable information for the improvement of the Mexican educational system under the new administration.

Senior Political Consultant
Pulso Legislativo, Mexico City, Mexico
April 2011 – December 2011

Ms. Ceballos served as a Senior Political Consultant for Pulso Legislativo for eight months from April through December 2011. Pulso Legislativo provided ad-hoc and tailored consulting services on legislative affairs for clients in Mexico. In this role, Ms. Ceballos developed tools and resources for the monitoring of relevant legislation and regulations for use by clients. She demonstrated her ability to effectively monitor key issues and stakeholders and share this information with clients for the development of informed and comprehensive strategies.

Program Liaison
Oportunidades Human Development Program, Ministry of Social Development (SEDESOL), Mexico City, Mexico
May 2010 – December 2010

Ms. Ceballos served as a Program Liaison for the Oportunidades Human Development program of the Ministry of Social Development for seven months, from May through December 2010. In this position, she networked with key government and private institutions in Mexico, promoting the objectives of the program. She advocated to ease the requirements scheme for the health components of the social protection program, seeking to create a more accessible program for Mexican citizens. Her work at SEDESOL, along with that of the partners she closely collaborated with, fostered the improvement of socioeconomic conditions and quality of life for program beneficiaries.

Junior Political Consultant
Chamber of Deputies, Mexico City, Mexico
September 2009 –April 2010

Ms. Ceballos served as a Junior Political Consultant at the Chamber of Deputies for seven months from September 2009 through April 2010. She was responsible for monitoring, analyzing and reporting on the work performed by the Finance, Economy and Communications Committees, as well as following up general legislative processes. Also, this position allowed her to learn lobbying techniques from both advocacy groups and the private sector during the negotiations around sugar and tobacco taxes. This position helped her to develop not only her monitoring, evaluation, and reporting skills, but also invaluable negotiation and advocacy strategies to advance the goals and objectives of her professional projects.

Liaison Analyst
National Electoral Institute, Mexico City, Mexico
March 2009 – July 2009

Ms. Ceballos served as a Liaison Analyst at the National Electoral Institute for four months from March through July 2009. In this role, she collaborated in designing the promotion strategies for the Preliminary Electoral Results Program (PREP). She also took part in the coordination of meetings with all political parties and with the Technical Advisory Committee for the PREP, in order to reach consensus on the program's operation and functioning. This role helped build her ability to collaborate with diverse entities to develop strategies that all involved parties support, helping her gain invaluable negotiation and communication skills.

EDUCATION

MSc, Global Health, *University of Southampton,* Southampton, United Kingdom 2016.

BSc, Political Science and Public Administration, *National Autonomous University of Mexico,* Mexico City, Mexico, 2009.

Diploma of U.S. Political Institutions and U.S. – Mexico Relations Program, *University of California, San Diego,* San Diego, California, 2020.

Diploma of Negotiation Skills - Santander Women Emerging Leaders Program, *London School of Economics and Political Science,* London, United Kingdom, 2021.

Diploma of STATA for Labor Market Analysis, *International Training Center of the International Labor Organization,* Turin, Italy, 2022.

Ms. Ingrid Amalia Ceballos Gastrado
Proposed Candidate for Project Director, Mexico Awareness Raising Project (MAP)
Partners of the Americas (POA)
September 2022

I. **Minimum of ten (10) years of experience in project management, supervision, administration, and implementation of cooperative agreement and/or contract requirements (including meeting deadlines, achieving targets, establishing, and maintaining systems for managing project operations, and overseeing the preparation and submission of required reports to donor agencies).**

Ms. Ingrid Ceballos brings over ten years of professional experience implementing and leading initiatives for the provision of public services and cross-sectoral collaboration in both the public and nonprofit sectors.

Since January 2019, she has served as the General Director for International Affairs Team at the Mexican Secretariat of Labor and Social Welfare (STPS), overseeing a team of twelve staff members and serving as the primary liaison between the STPS and other Mexican government counterparts and international organizations including the International Labor Organization (ILO), the G20, the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), and the Organization of American States (OAS), among others. She also manages a project portfolio of over 80 million U.S. dollars. This position demonstrates her ability to manage both her own team as a leader and guide cooperation between external organizations to build productive relationships and work towards shared goals with diverse groups of stakeholders while managing large and complex projects.

Ms. Ceballos has also worked for 11 months as the Director of Educational Affairs in the Ministry of Education in Mexico where she designed strategies and protocols for risk and crisis management. While working with the Ministry of Education, she developed communication strategies and led negotiations with professors' unions, further demonstrating her ability to facilitate cooperation among stakeholders, as well as experience working directly with unions.

As a Procurement Manager at the Mexican Institute for Family and Population Research, where she worked for nine months, Ms. Ceballos liaised and built relationships with strategic partners in pursuit of new funding opportunities. In this role, she worked with potential donors and assisted in the development of proposals for new projects in areas of health, education, productivity, and citizenship. This experience demonstrates Ms. Ceballos' experience with the development of project strategies, compliance with donor expectations, and cooperation with partners and other stakeholders.

Ms. Ceballos' additional experience includes serving in leadership roles, including two and a half years as the Deputy Director of Monitoring and Evaluation for the Chief of Staff's Office at the Presidency of the Republic; liaising and relationship-building roles, twelve months as a Senior Political Media Advisor, nine months as a Senior Political Consultant on legislative affairs, eight months as a program Liaison at the Ministry of Social development and five months as the Liaison Analyst at the National Electoral Institute, among relevant positions on political consulting and advising roles.

Partners of the Americas (POA) recognizes that Ms. Ceballos does not have experience in managing cooperative agreements funded specifically by the U.S. Government (USG). However, POA's home office will be working closely with Ms. Ceballos daily, providing training, guidance, and support to build her understanding of and ability to comply with USG-funded cooperative agreements including federal

rules and regulations (CFRs) and USDOL's Management Procedures and Guidelines (MPG). These efforts will include visits from home office staff to POA's office in Mexico City, and orientation meetings for the new Project Director in Washington, DC, trainings provided by POA's Chief Financial Officer and the Director of Grants and Compliance, courses on grant management such as those offered by Humentum, and daily check-ins with POA's Senior Director, who have a vast experience managing USG grants and cooperative agreements. Additionally, Ms. Ceballos will have the support of the Deputy Project Director, Director of Administration and Finance, Project Assistant, Finance Officer, and other POA staff in Mexico who have been working on the project and have developed a strong understanding of grants management and compliance.

POA's home office staff that will guide and support Ms. Ceballos through project implementation bring a wealth of experience managing USDOL funded projects. Therefore, POA feels confidently in its institutional ability to transfer and build Ms. Ceballos capacity regarding program management and USG- rules and regulations, compliance, among other relevant management skills. POA has previous experience bringing Project Director's with little or no experience in the implementation of USG funded projects, and successfully provided orientation, support and capacity building to bring them up to speed quickly into an effective operation.

II. Experience establishing and maintaining systems for managing project operations.

Ms. Ceballos has experience managing large teams and developing strategies and tools for successful project implementation. In her current role as the General Director of International affairs at STPS, she manages a team of twelve employees, and leads the development of STPS' cooperation agenda, coordinating efforts among STPS and its partners to effectively execute projects related to Mexico's labor reform. She leads her team in the development of workplans and adherence to schedules to ensure projects are completed efficiently and effectively.

As the Director of Educational Affairs at the Mexican Ministry of Education, Ms. Ceballos coordinated the Ministry's institutional risk agenda, including the design of strategies and protocols for risk and crisis management. This experience developed her ability to foresee and mitigate risks in project implementation.

While serving as the Deputy Director of Monitoring and Evaluation for the Chief of Staff's Office at the Presidency of the Republic, Ms. Ceballos developed activities to promote Mexico's advancements towards the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals and led the development of official reports on the country's progress in 2014 and 2016. This role demonstrates her ability to manage not only higher-level reporting and monitoring of project progress, but also an understanding of the day-to-day activities and efforts necessary for achieving larger project goals.

Ms. Ceballos' management experience reflects her diverse set of skills for managing a productive team, the implementation of activities, coordination with partners and stakeholders, risk management, and progress monitoring and reporting. She is a well-rounded leader with the necessary skills to ensure efficient and thorough project implementation.

POA will also support Ms. Ceballos by providing mentorship from a Senior M&E Advisor that will work closely with her on guiding the implementation of M&E requirements for USDOL funded projects. The Senior M&E Advisor will dedicate 50% LOE to the Mexico Awareness Raising project to provide a thorough orientation process including operationalizing the project's PMP, adjusting as needed to reflect the project needs and incorporating lessons learned and best practices from other USDOL projects. This

Senior M&E Advisor brings over 8 years of experience in the implementation of USDOL funded projects. This support will provide Ms. Ceballos with the hand on guidance and orientation needed to maintain systems and meet USDOL requirements for managing project operations, with a strong emphasis on M&E oversight and progress tracking.

III. **Proven success serving in a leadership role for a project addressing labor issues relevant to the project being funded under this cooperative agreement.**

Ms. Ceballos' experience as the Director of International Affairs at the STPS would prove invaluable to the implementation of the Mexico Awareness Raising Project (MAP). She has worked directly in the implementation and enforcement of Mexico's Labor Reform, which MAP seeks to promote among workers and worker organizations. She has experience in bi-lateral cooperation in her International Affairs-centered role demonstrating an advanced understanding of the United States–Mexico–Canada Agreement (USMCA), another key labor rights and trade agreement informing the activities of MAP. Her knowledge of and connections within the STPS will serve to strengthen the project's engagement with the government entity, facilitating in the development of their capacity to sustainably promote labor rights and compliance with the USMCA.

Additionally, MAP has had previous engagement with Ms. Ceballos while she served as a member of STPS leadership through meetings and events. She is already familiar with the project's activities, objectives, and staff. As such, she would enter this position with a solid understanding of MAP and its needs, goals, and strategies.

Ms. Ceballo's also has demonstrated abilities in communication and cooperation, two key elements of MAP's strategy. As Senior Political Media Advisor, in the Mexico Presidential Campaign, she coordinated the elaboration of strategic media reports, used to inform the development of messaging and communications strategies. . In this same position, she completed diagnostics of the educational sector, which she used to inform her reporting and the development of strategic plans.

Ms. Ceballo's experience working closely on the Mexican Labor Reform and the USMCA, along with her communication skills, demonstrate her knowledge of the key elements of this project, and her ability to lead MAP's efforts to achieve the objectives of the project and the USDOL.

IV. **Maintains working relationships with all project stakeholders and engages in coalition-building and public-private partnership promotion.**

Throughout her professional career, Ms. Ceballos has demonstrated her ability to build and maintain productive relationships with pertinent stakeholders and promote collaboration between the public, private, and non-profit sectors. In her role at the STPS, she is responsible for strengthening bilateral cooperation between the Secretariat's main partner institutions within the Mexican Government. She also serves as the primary liaison between the STPS and key international organizations such as ILO, G20, OECD, OAS and Pacific Alliance. Ms. Ceballos' current role with the STPS demonstrates her ability to serve as a leader in the development and maintenance of important relationships between the public and private sectors within and beyond Mexico. Furthermore, her leadership and partnership-building experiences within this role center on labor reform and rights- a skillset that would prove invaluable to the needs and objectives of MAP.

Additionally, in her role as the Director of Educational Affairs, Ms. Ceballos developed the Ministry of Education's communication strategies and negotiation tactics for educational governance for engagement and negotiations with professors' unions. This position demonstrates her ability to design and implement strategies for successful engagement with stakeholders, particularly pertaining to the Mexican Labor Reform and workers organizations, two central themes of this project. This position demonstrates her ability to not only engage with but ensure sustainable strategies for cooperation and collaboration with stakeholders, highlighting her communication and strategy-development skills.

While Ms. Ceballos served as the Procurement Manager at the Mexican Institute for Family and Population Research, she was the institutional liaison for relationship-building and strategic partnership. This role emphasized relationship-building for the purposes of project development and cooperative agreement management, showcasing her ability to foster relationships in the context of project management and expected outcomes.

In her position as Program Liaison for the Oportunidades Human Development program from the SEDESOL, Ms. Ceballos built and maintained working relationships with the local government and private institutions. She networked with entities from both sectors to identify shared goals and areas for collaboration in the improvement of socio-economic status and quality of life of project beneficiaries. She has a demonstrated ability to foster cross-sectoral coordination towards the achievement of shared goals and promotion of human rights.

V. **Bachelor's degree, Master's degree, or law or Juris Doctor (J.D.) degree reflecting expertise in areas relevant to this project, such as labor law, public policy, sociology, and project management.**

Ms. Ceballos has a bachelor's degree in Political Science and Public Administration (National Autonomous University of Mexico) and a master's degree in Global Health (University of Southampton, United Kingdom). She has also completed a Diploma of U.S. Political Institutions and US- Mexico Relations Program (University of California, San Diego), a Diploma of Diploma of Negotiation Skills - Santander Women Emerging Leaders Program (The London School of Economics, United Kingdom), and a Diploma of STATA for Labor Market Analysis (International Training Center of the International Labor Organization).

VI. **Fluency in English required (written and oral).**
VII. **Fluency in Spanish is required (written and oral)**

Ms. Ceballos' native language is Spanish. She is fluent in English and has received her master's degree and additional diplomas from English-speaking universities based in the United States and England.